PAPERS

RELATING TO THE

FOREIGN RELATIONS

OF

The United States,

TRANSMITTED TO CONGRESS,

WITH THE ANNUAL MESSAGE OF THE PRESIDENT,

DECEMBER 6, 1875.

PRECEDED BY A

LIST OF PAPERS AND FOLLOWED BY AN INDEX OF PERSONS AND SUBJECTS.

VOLUME II.



WASHINGTON:
GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE.
1875.

cers so appointed will travel in company with the gentlemen, and make everything as convenient for them in their journey as possible.

Hoping your excellency will be pleased to convey what is said above to Professor Davidson and the other gentlemen,

With respect and consideration,

TERASHIMA MUNENORI,
His Imperial Japanese Majesty's Minister for Foreign Affairs.

His Excellency J. A. BINGHAM,
Envoy Extraordinary and Minister Plenipotentiary of the United States.

[Inclosure 4 in No. 132.]

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Terashima.

No. 95.] UNITED STATES LEGATION,
Tokei, September 26, 1874.

YOUR EXCELLENCY: I have the honor to acknowledge your dispatch of the 25th instant, in which your excellency informs me that your government has, in accordance with my request, kindly granted a pass to Professor Davidson and his associates to visit any part of Japan for the purpose of observing, under the instructions of my Government, the transit of Venus. I have made known to Professor Davidson, as your excellency requested me to do, the purpose of your excellency's government to appoint officers to attend him and to obtain information of him as to his methods in this interesting work. I beg leave, in behalf of Professor Davidson, to thank your excellency's government for its proffered courtesy, and have the honor to inform your excellency that he will be pleased to have the Japanese officials attend him as proposed, and to impart to them the information desired. I beg leave, in behalf of my Government, to request that your excellency's government will telegraph the Japanese customs officials at Nagasaki to permit Mr. Edwards, the second assistant astronomer commissioned to this work, to receive from the Golden Age, upon its arrival in port, free of duty and without examination or delay, the instruments and outfit of the astronomical expedition, the property of my Government, and, when the work is completed, to reship the same without detention or payment of duties. I am authorized by Professor Davidson to say that there is nothing in this outfit but what especially appertains to the astronomical work assigned to him and his associates.

The professor also requests me to ask the further favor that your excellency's government will authorize the telegraph officials at Nagasaki to furnish him material and labor to aid him in constructing whatever short telegraph line he may have occasion to construct for the connection of his astronomical station with the cable and government lines at that port, the reasonable expenses of which the professor will pay. He also desires that your excellency's government will detail a government telegraph operator to assist him in the use of the telegraph lines, especially at night, for the determination of the difference of longitude, for which service also the professor will make payment.

Mr. Edwards has already gone forward on the Golden Age, and Professor Davidson leaves for Nagasaki on Thursday next, the 1st proximo. Your excellency will greatly oblige by sending the telegraph instructions to Nagasaki promptly, and by informing me of your action in the premises.

I have the honor to be your excellency's obedient servant,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

His Excellency TERASHIMA MUNENORI,
&c., &c., &c.

No. 363.

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Fish.

No. 132.] UNITED STATES LEGATION, JAPAN,
Tokei, October 8, 1874. (Received November 16.)

SIR: I have the honor to transmit herewith, for your information, a copy of a notification by the Japanese government to Chinese subjects resident in Japan (inclosure 1) informing them that in the event of

war between Japan and China they shall not be harmed by this government unless they engage in trade contraband of war, act as spies, or do other injury to this country. I have also the honor to inclose a copy of another notification (inclosure 2) which has reference to the Japanese expedition to Formosa, the occurrences there between the Japanese forces, and the efforts at negotiation by the ministers sent to China by Japan, &c. It is to be observed in this last notification that while it is said that the Emperor desires a peaceful result by negotiation, it is clearly stated therein that preparations are being made for war in the event of a failure to settle the difficulties by negotiation. A notice appearing in the papers that Mr. Wasson, the American citizen mentioned in my dispatches of April last, was recently in Nagasaki, awaiting orders to report to General Saigo, the Japanese commander in Formosa, I took occasion to request the minister for foreign affairs, by a dispatch of date the 1st instant, (inclosure 3,) to notify Mr. Wasson of the fact hitherto communicated to you, that he (Wasson) was detached from that service and should not proceed to Formosa. I have the honor to further inform you that in the latter part of September I received from Mr. Seward, at Shanghai, a dispatch of date the 1st ultimo, inclosing a note identically agreed upon by the foreign consuls at Shanghai for the protection of foreign commerce, &c., in the event of hostilities between Japan and China, (inclosures 4 and 5.) To this communication I replied in a letter (inclosure 6) dated the 25th ultimo. I respectfully submit the same for your consideration, hoping that my action may meet your approval, and especially desiring your instructions in the matter. I have this evening received a communication from the minister for foreign affairs asking me what Chinese, if any, are in the service of this legation, and requesting me to notify him in future if any Chinese shall be employed at the legation or discharged therefrom. To this I have replied that there are no Chinese in the employ of the legation at present, and that should any be employed therein or discharged therefrom in the future I shall inform him.

I am, &c.,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

[Inclosure 1 in No. 132.—Translation.]

NOTIFICATION TO CHINESE SUBJECTS.

[From the Japan Weekly Mail, October 3, 1874.]

Chinese subjects.—The wicked inhabitants of Formosa have, in former years, murdered and plundered several tens of our Japanese subjects. Steps have, therefore, been taken to punish these offenses, and to protect our subjects from injury in the future. To this the Chinese government have objected, and our government has therefore dispatched officials to discuss this matter, but no conclusion has yet been arrived at. We hear that you, the Chinese subjects, resident in this country, are unnecessarily apprehensive lest it should be impossible to preserve peace between the two countries, and that, if war broke out, your persons would be imprisoned, and your property plundered and confiscated, and we are informed that you torment yourselves with all kinds of anxieties. If this is truly the case, your condition is a very pitiable one. But even if war should unavoidably break out, in what are you, the Chinese subjects, resident here, to blame? Except in the case of persons guilty of contraband trading, spying, or doing injury to this country connected with the war, the government of great Japan will neither imprison or plunder you. Take careful note of this, obey the instructions of this government, pursue your occupations in peace, and do not allow yourselves to be carried away by excitement.

(The above was notified on the 29th September to Chinese subjects resident in Japan in the Chinese and Japanese languages.)

SANJO SANEYOSHI,
Daijo Daijin, [Prime Minister.]

[Inclosure 2 in No. 132.—Translation.]

NOTIFICATION NO. 127 AS TO FORMOSA.

To the In, Sho, Shi, Fu, and Ken:

An expedition against the barbarous part of Formosa was announced in notification No. 65 of May last, and on the 22d of that month the commander-in-chief, Saijo Yorimichi, arrived there. The troops had arrived some days previously. They entered the territory of the savages, and were exploring its lands and waters when they were suddenly fired upon by them. Our troops then attacked them, and put them to rout. Eighteen heads of villages gave in their submission, one after another, and almost the whole savage territory was reduced to peace. We were thereafter engaged in preparing preventive measures for the future, when the Chinese government persistently objected. Yanagiwara Sakimitsu, our envoy extraordinary and minister plenipotentiary to that country, was therefore instructed to discuss the matter with the Chinese government, and numerous written communications and conferences were held. The further special step was then taken of dispatching to China Okubo Toschimichi as high commissioner plenipotentiary. It is, of course, the aim of His Majesty that these negotiations shall result in a peaceful settlement and in the preservation of amicable relations, but preparations are at the same time being made to meet any emergency in case circumstances leave us no other alternative than to do so.

His Majesty will give you his further commands with reference to the result of the negotiations to be conducted henceforward by our high commissioner to China.

SANJO SANEYOSHI,
Daijo Daijin.

SEPTEMBER 28, 1874.

[Inclosure 3 in No. 132.]

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Terashima.

No. 87.] UNITED STATES LEGATION,
Tokei, October 1, 1874.

YOUR EXCELLENCY: I called at your office yesterday for the purpose of acquainting you with the fact that Mr. Wasson, a citizen of the United States, hitherto referred to by your excellency in your No. 26 of date the 22d April last addressed to me, and who, as your excellency then informed me, had, by the action of your excellency's government upon my request, been detached from service under the Japanese government in the Formosan expedition, is reported in the Japan Gazette of the 29th ultimo to be "in Nagasaki awaiting instructions to resume his position on General Saijo's staff," and "will probably sail for Formosa in a few days."

I have the honor to further inform your excellency that I communicated to my Government copies of my communications heretofore made to your excellency in which I protested against the employment of United States citizens and vessels in the Japanese expedition against Formosa, and a copy of your excellency's dispatch of the 22d of April, setting forth the action of your excellency's government as above stated, to which my Government has replied that the proceedings taken by me to detach the citizens of the United States and the steamer New York are approved. Not doubting that the instructions heretofore issued, as stated by your excellency, for the detachment of Mr. Wasson and the other citizens of the United States named in your excellency's dispatch of 22d of April were in accordance with the treaty obligations subsisting between the United States and Japan, and feeling quite assured that it has been and is the purpose of your excellency's government to carry the same out in good faith, I beg leave to respectfully request that your excellency will notify Mr. Wasson of the instructions issued by your government detaching him from service in the Japanese expedition against Formosa, to the end that he may not proceed to Formosa, in violation alike of the instructions of your excellency's government and of the laws of his country.

I have the honor to be your excellency's obedient servant,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

His Excellency TERASHIMA MUNENORI,
&c., &c., &c.

[Inclosure 4 in No. 132.]

Mr. Seward to Mr. Bingham.

No. 24.] UNITED STATES CONSULATE-GENERAL,
Shanghai, September 1, 1874.

SIR: I have the honor to hand you herewith a draught of a dispatch which has been addressed by the several consuls at this port to their several ministers at Peking, looking to the need of action to secure the safety of our commerce and of our settlements in the event of war between China and Japan.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

GEO. F. SEWARD,
Consul-General.

Hon. JOHN A. BINGHAM,
United States Minister to Japan, Yeddo.

[Inclosure 5 in No. 132.]

Draught of an identical note to be sent by each consul to his ministerial representative at Peking.

SIR: The probability of a war between China and Japan having of late attracted much attention, and the possibility of such a contingency not by any means having passed over, it has occurred to myself and some of my colleagues to consider what would be the position of the foreign settlements of Shanghai in such an unfortunate event, and how far it would be expedient to adopt such precautions as may render that position a comparatively safe one. It does not need any extraordinary foresight to predict that Shanghai, from its importance as a commercial center, and from its proximity to one of the few arsenals which China possesses, will become a focus of attack in case of hostilities being declared, and in that event the foreign settlements will be at once exposed to extreme danger, inasmuch as they stand (that portion called British more especially) exactly in a quarter where any outworks necessary to cover the city from hostile approach by the river must be constructed.

No move has been as yet made by the Chinese toward the utilization of this strategical position, but they may at any moment see fit to occupy it, and should they do so, and hostilities supervene, the consequences to neutral life and property may be very serious. The conclusion appears to myself and colleagues obvious, that, if such a sacrifice can be in any way averted, no effort ought to be left untried to avert it; and the alternative we would venture to propose is that advantage should be taken of the presence in Peking of a Japanese minister plenipotentiary, to negotiate for the neutralization of the ground covered by the foreign settlements, and a stipulation that nothing shall be done on either side to endanger the safety of the residents therein or of the property in their keeping. The Tautai of this place, it is believed, will be quite willing to give his consent to this proposition, and I beg to submit it to your excellency, in conjunction with such of my colleagues as are more directly interested, and each of whom has addressed an identical note to his minister, in the hope that the scheme may meet with your favorable consideration. I may refer here to the 26th article of the United States treaty with China, which provides for the immunity of American commerce in case of war, and to suggest that such further negotiation may be undertaken with the Japanese as will render this provision operative as far as they are concerned; and, in this connection, it may be mentioned that the Chinese are likely to obstruct the Woosung Bar in case of war, unless some means are adopted to prevent them taking this course. Various and serious questions, it must be confessed, will be involved in the adoption of the proposed measure; but as these must of necessity occur to your mind, and their discussion scarcely comes within my province, I prefer to submit the simple proposition, free of all observation or remark.

My colleagues agree with me that it is also beyond our province to propose that any arrangements arrived at shall embrace all the foreign settlements in China and Japan, but it may not be amiss to point out how obviously desirable such an extension would be.

[Inclosure 6 in No. 132.]

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Seward.

No. 102.] UNITED STATES LEGATION,
Tokei, September 25, 1874.

SIR: I have to acknowledge the receipt of your dispatches 23 and 24, dated the 7th August and the 1st September, respectively, and tender you my thanks for the same.

The regulations of the consular courts in China, inclosed with your No. 23, upon such examination as I have been able to give them, seem to me satisfactory and worthy of consideration here. The note identical, inclosed in your No. 24, I consider to be called for in the present exigency, and should war be declared between Japan and China, the adoption of the same should be insisted on by the foreign representatives accredited to both nations. I have this to suggest: that the foreign settlements, or places exclusively occupied by foreigners, in each empire, should be declared by the sovereign authority of each inviolate in the event of war, and should be respected alike by the forces of Japan and China. What is said in the note identical touching the 26th article of the United States treaty with China is a matter of the first importance to the people of the United States, and it shall be my pleasure, as it is my duty, to co-operate with you and with all the representatives of our common country in securing to our people the full benefit of that article, if, unhappily, a public, solemn war shall obtain between Japan and China.

I am, sir, your obedient servant,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

GEO. F. SEWARD, Esq., &c.,
Shanghai.

No. 364.

Mr. Cadwalader to Mr. Bingham.

No. 84.] DEPARTMENT OF STATE,
Washington, November 6, 1874.

SIR: Referring to your dispatch No. 27, in relation to the facilities extended Professor Davidson and his associates by the Japanese government to enable them to make observations of the transit of Venus, a copy of which was communicated to the Secretary of the Navy, I transmit herewith a transcript of a letter addressed to this Department by Admiral Reynolds, acting Secretary of the Navy, requesting that the thanks of the Navy Department be conveyed to the authorities of Japan for the facilities extended to the party referred to for the purposes therein mentioned. I will consequently thank you to comply with his request.

I am, &c.,

JOHN L. CADWALADER,
Acting Secretary.

[Inclosure in No. 84.]

Admiral Reynolds to Mr. Cadwalader.

NAVY DEPARTMENT,
Washington, November 5, 1874.

SIR: The Department is gratified to receive your letter of the 3d instant and its inclosures.

I have the honor to request that you will convey to the authorities of Japan the thanks of the Department for the facilities extended Professor Davidson, United States Navy, and his associates, to enable them properly to observe the transit of Venus; also to Mr. Bingham for his prompt action in the matter.

I am, sir, very respectfully, your obedient servant.

WM. REYNOLDS,
Acting Secretary of the Navy.

The Honorable JOHN L. CADWALADER,
Acting Secretary of State.

No. 374.

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Fish.

No. 179.] UNITED STATES LEGATION, JAPAN,
Tokei, January 29, 1875. (Received February 27.)

SIR: On the 23d instant there appeared in the Japan Mail, published in Yokohama, a translation of the "Address of Okuma Shigenobu, as president of the Formosan commission, to His Majesty," the Emperor of Japan, a copy of which is herewith inclosed. (Inclosure 1.)

This address is so extraordinary in some of its statements that the diplomatic representatives of the foreign powers accredited to His Majesty's government deemed it proper to hold a general consultation, with a view to determine what action, if any, should be taken by them to correct the erroneous statement made in the address touching their official action in the matter of the Formosan expedition. This consultation was held yesterday at the British legation, all the foreign representatives being present except the Austro Hungarian minister, who is absent. The representatives present agreed that the written statement herewith inclosed (inclosure 2) should be read to the Japanese minister for foreign affairs, to the end that the same, or the substance thereof, might be published by the authority of His Majesty's government in correction of the address of Mr. Okuma.

You will observe that it is not intended that this paper shall be published as the paper of the representatives of the foreign powers, but as the correction by the Japanese government of so much of the address as reflects unjustly upon the foreign ministers. This action was deemed judicious because, as you will doubtless notice, the address states that "after our (their) troops had started and were on their way, foreign public servants remonstrated." In the Japanese text as published, this statement refers expressly to the foreign representatives as the public servants who remonstrated. This statement is manifestly calculated, when read in connection with the context, to create the impression that the foreign ministers questioned the right of His Majesty's government to invade Formosa with His Majesty's ships and troops. There was nothing in my communications with this government, as you are already advised by my dispatches to the Department, which gives even colorable excuse for the statement of Mr. Okuma, and I am assured by my colleagues that the same may be said of the action of each of them. I did protest, as I deemed it my duty, against the employment by the Japanese government of ships and citizens of the United States in an armed and hostile expedition to Formosa, without the consent of China, and in violation of our treaty obligations to the government of that country. The statement of Mr. Okuma is all the more surprising when it is considered that this government approved my protest and accordingly issued an order detaching the American ship New York and the American citizens, Mr. Le Gendre, Captain Casell, and Mr. Wasson, from the Formosan expedition, days before any part of the expedition sailed from Nagasaki. I beg leave, in this connection, to refer generally to all my dispatches to the Department on the Formosan question, and especially to my dispatches Nos. 76* and 78*, dated respectively the 22d and 24th of April, 1874.

In view of the recent murder by a Japanese, of the acting German consul, Mr. Haber, on account of the supposed hostility of foreigners

* See Foreign Relations for 1874, pages 675 and 681.

to the policy of His Majesty, it seems somewhat remarkable that Mr. Okuma should have put into his "address to His Majesty," first, a complaint against the foreign ministers, to the effect that they opposed His Majesty's orders for the armed invasion of Formosa, and that he should have followed this with the further statement that "important interests were involved in the chastisement of the savages," and that he should have finally added, in concluding his address, the ambiguous words, "I humbly pray that His Majesty, the Tenno, will eagerly carry on the work, * * * and that he will not stop with the chastisement of the savages."

When this address was made all the Japanese forces had returned from Formosa, yet "the work" is to be carried on, and is not to stop with the chastisement of the savages or Formosans.

In view of the several statements in the address, it seems to me the public explanation asked for by the foreign ministers is due alike to them and to their respective governments.

Hoping that my action in the premises will accord with your judgment, and receive your approval,

I am, &c.,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

[Inclosure 2 in No. 179.—Translation.]

ADDRESS OF ŌKUMA SHIGENOBU, AS PRESIDENT OF THE FORMOSAN COMMISSION, TO HIS MAJESTY.

[From the "Japan Mail" of Seib, 23 January, 1875.]

NISSHIN SHINJISSHI, *No.* 10, *January* 15, 1875.

In the month of January, Shigenobu and others, in accordance with the confidential instructions they had received, laid before your Majesty a project for the chastisement of the savages. In April the Formosan commission (lit. board of affairs of the savage land of Formosa) was instituted, and Shigenobu was appointed its chief, to superintend all business belonging to it. In May the commander-in-chief, Saigo Yorimichi, departed to the land of the savages at the head of a force, exterminated the wicked, pardoned the submissive, and remained there a long time encamped. During the same month the minister plenipotentiary, Yanagiwara Sakimitsu, was dispatched to China, and in August the high commissioner plenipotentiary, Ōkubō Toshimichi, also was sent to the said country. Toshimichi and the others worked diligently and devotedly in the discharge of the important trust committed to them. In October, a convention was exchanged with the said country, and in November, Toshimichi and the rest reported the fulfillment of their mission. In December, Yoimichi returned in triumph. From the institution of the commission up to this date a period of eight months had elapsed. Hereupon the wrongs of the sufferers were for the first time redressed, the position of a subject *han* for the first time cleared up, security restored to the mariners of all countries for the first time, and the dignity and influence of the state consequently vindicated.

After our troops had started and were on the way, foreign public servants remonstrated. The Chinese government hastily dispatched an envoy, sent letters, and manifested a wide difference of opinion. Some persons, not comprehending the views of the government, began to doubt whether it was justified in the course which it was taking; others discussed the want of funds, and rumor became so noisy that the state was again imperilled.

Shigenobu and the others nevertheless accepted the responsibility, but day and night they were so busily employed that they feared lest their strength might be unequal to the task. Fortunately, the wise resolution of His Majesty the Tenno, never wavered, and the councils of the government became still more resolute. Great military preparations were made, and the mind of the people, both in the towns and in the country, learned to recognize the purpose of His Majesty. Some desired to cast away their lives and to die for the national cause; others offered to contribute toward the army expenditure. The civil and military officers united all their efforts, and the

great work of chastising the savages became an accomplished fact. We have nothing to be ashamed of before foreign nations concerning this measure, and its glory will not pale before the deeds done in ancient times.

If, while public rumor was clamorous, we had hesitated or drawn back, the injuries done to the sufferers would not have been redressed, the position of a dependent *han* would not have been cleared up, the mariners of the world would never have known security, and a land of cannibals would have been established forever. Had such been the result, we should not only have been disgraced in the eyes of the world, but it would have been a sign that the dignity and influence of the state were about to fall prostrate. Consequently, important interests were involved in the chastisement of the savages.

I humbly pray that His Majesty the Tenno will eagerly carry on the work and carefully ponder; that by reflecting on the past he may be enabled to think out the policy of the future, so as to exalt his wise work to the highest pinnacle and glory, and that he will not stop with the chastisement of the savages.

Shigenobu reverently begs that the name of Formosan commission be now abolished, and himself relieved of the title of president, so that he may attend to the duties of his proper office. As for the collection of the documents of the commission and the audit of the accounts, this he hopes may be completed by the officials of the regular service in about a month, and a report can then be made, together with a detailed account of all that has been done since the institution of the commission.

[Inclosure 2 in No. 179.]

Written statement of the foreign ministers.

The address of the Japanese minister of finance to His Majesty the Tenno, on the subject of the Formosan expedition, contains a passage which is calculated to create an incorrect impression. The foreign ministers did not remonstrate against the dispatch of the Japanese troops to Formosa, but some of them protested against the employment by Japan of their ships and subjects or citizens until it was known whether such employment would or would not be regarded in a hostile light by China. Their treaty relations with China fully justified this course, and it must not be supposed that the foreign ministers remonstrated with the government of Japan against the employment of Japanese ships and troops.

No. 375.

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Fish.

No. 183.] UNITED STATES LEGATION, JAPAN,
Tokei, February 9, 1875. (Received April 2.)

SIR: Referring to my dispatch of date 29th January last, (No. 179,)* in relation to the address of his excellency Okuma Shigenobu, sanji to His Majesty the Tenno, and to the demand made by the foreign representatives for the correction thereof, I have the honor to say that his excellency Mr. Okuma has made the correction as requested, by a publication in the official journal in which his original address appeared, to wit, the Tokio Nichi-Nichi Shimbun, (the Tokio Daily News,) under date the 3d instant, a translation of which, as published in the Japan Weekly Mail of date February 6, 1875, I herewith inclose.

I am, &c.,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

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*Ante.

[Inclosure in No. 183.—Translation.]

Mr. Okuma's correction of his address to His Majesty the Tenno, as published in the Japan Weekly Mail of February 6, 1875, and in the Japan Daily Herald of February 8, 1875.

[From the Japan Daily Herald of February 8, 1875.]

Translation from the Japan Mail.
From the Tokio Nichi-Nichi Shimbun, February 3.

My address to the Throne of the 4th instant contains the following passage:

"After our troops had started, and were on their way, foreign public servants* remonstrated."

Your excellency having asked for an explanation of this passage, on the demand o the foreign representatives, it becomes necessary that I should state that the foreign representatives did not remonstrate against the dispatch of Japanese troops to Formosa, but some of them, stating that their treaty relations with China obliged them to take this course, protested against the employment by Japan, in the Formosan expedition, of their ships and subjects or citizens, until it was known whether such employment would or would not be regarded in a hostile light by China.

I humbly make this representation.

OKUMA SHIGENOBU SANJI,

To His Excellency SANJO,
Daijo Daijin.

No. 376.

Mr. Bingham to Mr. Fish.

No. 191.] UNITED STATES LEGATION, JAPAN,
Tokei, February 17, 1875. (Received April 2.)

SIR: I have the honor to acquaint you with the fact, as appears by the official communications of the diplomatic representatives of England and France and his excellency the Japanese minister for foreign affairs, (copies of which, as published in the Japan Herald of date the 16th instant, are herewith inclosed; inclosures 1 and 2,) that those two powers have, of their own motion, concluded that "the time has now arrived when the small British and French force now in Yokohama should be withdrawn." * * *

Whatever may have led to this action, it seems to me to be a timely recognition of the capacity and the right of Japan to furnish the needful force to maintain the peace within her own territory. This withdrawal of the foreign land force may well be taken as some indication that the two powers named considered this action on their part to be called for in their own interests.

I am, &c.,

JNO. A. BINGHAM.

[Inclosure 1 in No. 191.]

British and French ministers to the minister for foreign affairs.

[From the "Japan Herald," February 16, 1875.]

YEDO, *January* 27, 1875.

MONSIEUR LE MINISTRE: In conjunction with my colleague, the minister of France, I have the honor of informing your excellency that our governments consider that the

*The term used may also be translated "foreign ministers."